PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

April 22, 2026
Community Engagement Session: School Rightsizing

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Portland Public Schools Board of Education Community Engagement Session was held at Ida B. Wells High School at 1151 SW Vermont St, Portland, OR 97219, and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Board Members Present: Christy Splitt, Virginia La Forte, Stephanie Engelsman, Eddie Wang, Student Representative Ian Ritorto

Staff: Kimberlee Armstrong - Superintendent; Ayesha Coning - Principal; Margaret Calvert - Assistant Superintendent; Nichole Watson - Senior Director of Family and Community Engagement; Filip Hristic - Senior Director of 6-12 Academics; Dana Stiles - Director of Early Learners; Richard Smith - Senior Director, Data and Accountability.

Call to Order and Introductions
The meeting was called to order at 6:06 pm.

Welcome + Grounding
Principal Ayesha Conning welcomed everyone. Superintendent Armstrong and Board Members introduced themselves and stated what they were hoping to learn. Nichole Watson provided an overview of the structure of the evening and shared community norms.

Historical Context
Superintendent Armstrong provided context for the need to consolidate, citing declining enrollment, large and growing budget gap, and aging facilities. Staff provided the timeline for engagement leading up to a recommendation.

Learning Lab Rounds
Participants were able to ask questions of subject matter experts: Filip Hristic and Dana Stiles for Academics, and Richard Smith for Data. Common themes included a desire to maintain focus options, requests for financial transparency including cost-savings data, concerns about equity for historically underserved students, the potential for new housing growth that could offset enrollment declines in some areas, and the belief that state funding shortfalls as the root of the problem.

Board Remarks
Board Members provided closing remarks.

Closing
Chair Wang thanked attendees, staff, and subject matter experts, and shared upcoming engagement opportunities.

Adjournment

The session ended at 7:57 pm.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
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Portland Public Schools